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PSAC Exam Practice Platform — Specimen Paper

2026

History & Geography

Grade 6 — Primary School Achievement Certificate

Specimen Paper 3

Focus: Independence & Post-independence • Industries of Mauritius

Duration: 1 hour 45 minutes **Total Marks:** 100

Candidate Name: _____

School: _____

Index Number: _____

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Answer **ALL** questions in all sections.
2. Write your answers in the spaces provided.
3. This paper has **FOUR sections**: A, B, C and D.
4. Section A: Map Work and Economic Geography — 25 marks
5. Section B: History of Mauritius (Independence & Post-independence) — 35 marks
6. Section C: Geography of Mauritius (Industries) — 25 marks
7. Section D: Civics and Heritage — 15 marks
8. Read each question carefully before answering.
9. Marks for each question are shown in brackets [].
10. Do not open this booklet until you are told to do so.

SECTION A — MAP WORK AND ECONOMIC GEOGRAPHY [25 marks]

1. Study the economic activity map of Mauritius below and answer the questions that follow. [13]

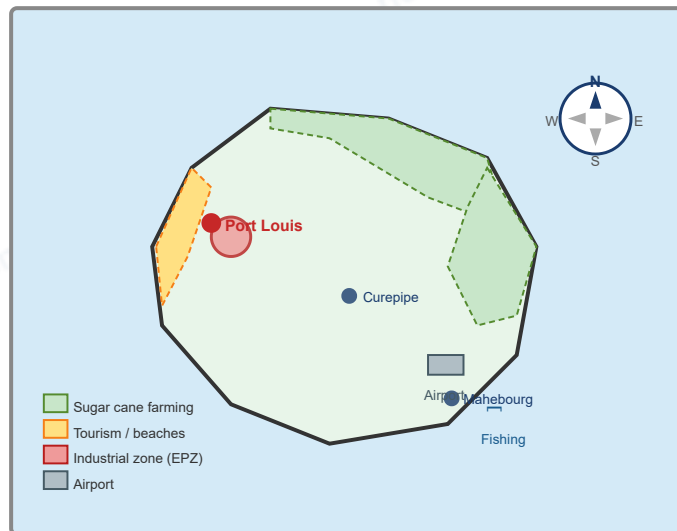


Fig. 3 — Simplified economic activity map of Mauritius

- (a) According to the map, in which parts of Mauritius is sugar cane farming mainly found? [2]

- (b) Which area of the map shows an industrial zone (EPZ)? Near which major city is it located? [2]

- (c) Which coast of Mauritius is mainly used for tourism? [1]

- (d) Where is the international airport of Mauritius located? Why is it important for the economy? [2]

- (e) The port of Port Louis is vital to Mauritius. Give **two** reasons why the port is important to the Mauritian economy. [2]

- (f) Using the map, suggest why the western coast might be more popular for tourism than the eastern coast. [2]

- (g) Name **two** transport links shown or implied by the map that are important for trade and tourism in Mauritius. [2]

2. Answer the following questions about the economic geography of Mauritius. [12]

- (a) What does EPZ stand for? What is an Export Processing Zone? [2]

- (b) Tick ONE correct answer. The EPZ in Mauritius was mainly set up to produce: [1]

- ☐ A Cars and heavy machinery
☐ B Textiles and garments for export
☐ C Fishing equipment
☐ D Coal and oil products

- (c) List the **four** main pillars (sectors) of the Mauritian economy. [4]

- (d) Read Source A and answer the questions below. [5]

Source A: Economic Transformation of Mauritius

"At independence in 1968, Mauritius depended almost entirely on sugar cane. Sugar made up 93% of export earnings and employed over 35% of the workforce. In the 1970s, the government established Export Processing Zones (EPZs) to attract foreign investment in manufacturing, particularly textiles. In the 1980s, tourism was developed as a third pillar. Since the

1990s, Mauritius has developed into a financial and ICT services hub. Today, no single sector dominates and Mauritius is described as a diversified, middle-income economy."

- (i) At independence, what percentage of export earnings came from sugar? [1]

- (ii) According to Source A, in which decade did the Mauritian government develop tourism? [1]

- (iii) What does "diversified economy" mean? Use Source A to explain your answer. [2]

- (iv) Why was it important for Mauritius to diversify its economy away from sugar? Give **one** reason. [1]

SECTION B — HISTORY: INDEPENDENCE AND POST-INDEPENDENCE

[35 marks]

3. Answer the following questions about the road to independence.

[14]

(a) On what date did Mauritius gain independence from Britain? [2]

(b) Who was the first Prime Minister of independent Mauritius? By what title is he remembered? [2]

(c) Who was Gaetan Duval? Which political party did he lead? [2]

(d) Complete the independence timeline. [6]

- **1936** — Mauritius Labour Party (MLP) founded by _____
- **1948** — _____ (Extension of voting rights)
- **1959** — First general elections under universal adult suffrage; MLP wins with _____ as leader
- **1965** — _____ (Constitutional conference on independence)
- **12 March 1968** — _____
- **12 March 1992** — _____ (Mauritius becomes a Republic)

(e) Tick ONE correct answer. Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam is remembered as the "Father of the Nation" because he: [1]

- ☐ A Was the first President of the Republic
- ☐ B Led Mauritius to independence and became its first Prime Minister
- ☐ C Founded the sugar industry
- ☐ D Built Port Louis harbour

- (f) Name **one** important social or economic achievement of Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam during his time as Prime Minister. [1]

4. Answer the following questions about post-independence Mauritius. [13]

- (a) In which year did Mauritius become a Republic? What changed when Mauritius became a Republic? [2]

- (b) Who was the first President of the Republic of Mauritius? [1]

- (c) Read Source B carefully and answer the questions below. [6]

Source B: Post-independence development

"At independence in 1968, Mauritius was considered a poor country with few prospects. Experts warned of overpopulation and poverty. Yet within three decades, Mauritius had transformed itself into one of Africa's most prosperous nations. Universal free primary and secondary education was introduced, improving literacy rates dramatically. A public health system was established, reducing infant mortality. Investment in new industries created jobs for thousands. By the 1990s, Mauritius was regarded as an economic miracle and a model of successful development in the developing world."

- (i) According to Source B, how was Mauritius described at independence? [1]

- (ii) Name **two** social improvements mentioned in Source B. [2]

- (iii) What does Source B mean by "economic miracle"? Use evidence from the source in your answer. [2]

(iv) Do you think education was important to the economic success of Mauritius? Explain why. [1]

(d) Name **one** important political leader who came after independence and describe **one** achievement of that leader. [2]

(e) Tick ONE correct answer. The national motto of Mauritius is: [1]

- ☐ A "Unity and Justice"
- ☐ B "Stella Clavisque Maris Indici" (Star and Key of the Indian Ocean)
- ☐ C "Freedom and Prosperity"
- ☐ D "One People, One Nation"

5. **Essay Question** — answer in continuous prose.

[8]

Describe the importance of Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam to Mauritius. In your answer, include: his background and early political career; his role in the independence movement; his achievements as Prime Minister; and how he is remembered today. [8]

SECTION C — GEOGRAPHY OF MAURITIUS: INDUSTRIES [25 marks]

6. Answer the following questions about the main industries of Mauritius.

[13]

- (a) Study the pie chart description below and answer the questions. [4]

Approximate contribution to Mauritius GDP (2024):

- Services (financial, ICT, tourism): 74%
- Manufacturing (textiles, food processing): 14%
- Agriculture (sugar, food crops): 4%
- Construction & other: 8%

- (i) Which sector contributes the most to Mauritius's GDP? [1]

- (ii) What percentage does agriculture contribute to GDP? How has this changed since independence (when sugar dominated)? [2]

- (iii) What does GDP mean? [1]

- (b) Explain the importance of tourism to Mauritius. Give **three** ways in which tourism benefits the country. [3]

- (c) Name **two** problems that tourism can cause in Mauritius. [2]

- (d) What is the ICT (Information and Communications Technology) sector? Why is it important to the future of Mauritius? [2]

- (e) Tick ONE correct answer. Mauritius is known internationally as: [1]

- ☐ A A major oil-producing nation
- ☐ B A financial services hub and upmarket tourist destination
- ☐ C A large manufacturing economy
- ☐ D A major diamond exporter

- (f) Give **one** advantage and **one** disadvantage of Mauritius relying heavily on tourism for its income. [1]

7. Answer the following questions about agriculture and manufacturing in Mauritius. [12]

- (a) Describe the sugar cane industry in Mauritius. Include: where it is grown; how sugar is produced; and its importance to Mauritius historically. [4]

- (b) Name **two** food crops (other than sugar cane) grown in Mauritius. [2]

- (c) What advantages did Mauritius offer to foreign textile companies in the EPZ? Give **two** reasons why companies invested in the EPZ. [2]

(d) Read Source C and answer the questions below. [4]

Source C: The fishing industry in Mauritius

"Mauritius has one of the largest Exclusive Economic Zones (EEZ) in the world, covering approximately 2.3 million square kilometres of the Indian Ocean. This gives the island nation exclusive rights to fishing and mineral resources in these waters. Tuna fishing is the most important commercial fishery, and Mauritius exports canned tuna to Europe. Small-scale coastal fishermen also fish the lagoon and reef for local consumption. Sustainable fishing practices are increasingly important as fish stocks come under pressure."

(i) What is the size of Mauritius's EEZ according to Source C? [1]

(ii) Which type of fish is most important commercially in Mauritius? Where is it mainly exported? [2]

(iii) Why are "sustainable fishing practices" important? [1]

SECTION D — CIVICS AND HERITAGE [15 marks]

8. Answer the following questions about the Republic of Mauritius and its government.

[8]

- (a) What is the full official name of our country? [1]

- (b) Describe the role of the Prime Minister of Mauritius. Give **two** responsibilities of the Prime Minister. [2]

- (c) What is the Supreme Court? What is its role in the Mauritian system of government? [2]

- (d) Name **three** national public holidays of Mauritius and state what each celebrates. [3]

9. Answer the following questions about democracy and citizenship in Mauritius.

[7]

- (a) What is democracy? Give **one** feature of a democratic system. [2]

- (b) What is the role of a Member of Parliament (MP) in Mauritius? [2]

(c) Tick ONE correct answer. In a democracy, the government gets its authority from: [1]

- ☐ A The army
- ☐ B The people through free and fair elections
- ☐ C The wealthiest citizens
- ☐ D A foreign government

(d) Name **two** rights that every citizen of Mauritius has under the constitution. [2]

End of Paper 3 — Check your work before handing in. Total: 100 marks.

Mark Scheme — Specimen Paper 3 (2026)

For teacher / parent use only. Accept any reasonable answer that demonstrates correct understanding. Marks for essays: award based on knowledge content, clarity and structure. Award marks generously.

Q	Answer	Marks
1(a)	North and east of the island	2
1(b)	Near Port Louis (1); west / northwest area (1)	2
1(c)	West coast	1
1(d)	Southeast of the island near Mahebourg (1); it connects Mauritius to the world for tourists and exports / imports (1)	2
1(e)	Any two: importing goods; exporting sugar/textiles/fish; receiving tourists by ship; container traffic; source of employment (1 each)	2
1(f)	The west is drier / more sheltered / calmer seas (1); west has calmer lagoon conditions suitable for beach tourism (1)	2
1(g)	Any two: sea port; international airport; road network; shipping lanes (1 each)	2
2(a)	EPZ = Export Processing Zone (1); a special industrial area where goods (mainly textiles) are manufactured for export, often with tax incentives (1)	2
2(b)	B — Textiles and garments for export	1
2(c)	Any four: sugar/agriculture; textiles/manufacturing; tourism; financial services; ICT/services (1 each)	4
2(d)(i)	93%	1
2(d)(ii)	The 1980s	1
2(d)(iii)	A diversified economy does not depend on just one sector (1); Mauritius has developed sugar, textiles, tourism and ICT so that no single industry dominates (1)	2
2(d)(iv)	Any one: if one sector fails (e.g. sugar price drops) the whole economy would collapse; relying on one product is risky; diversification creates more jobs and stability	1
3(a)	12 March 1968 (1 for date, 1 for year — accept any reasonable combination)	2
3(b)	Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam (SSR) (1); "Father of the Nation" (1)	2
3(c)	Gaetan Duval was a political leader and lawyer (1); Parti Mauricien Social Démocrate (PMSD) (1)	2
3(d) timeline	1936: Dr Maurice Cure (1); 1948: Extension of voting rights / franchise extended (1); 1959: Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam (1); 1965: Lancaster House Conference (1);	6

Q	Answer	Marks
	1968: Independence of Mauritius (1); 1992: Mauritius becomes a Republic (1)	
3(e)	B — Led Mauritius to independence and became its first Prime Minister	1
3(f)	Any one: free education; public health system; EPZs / industrialisation; welfare state; national airline; port development	1
4(a)	1992 (1); Mauritius became a Republic, replacing the British monarch with a Mauritian President as Head of State (1)	2
4(b)	Sir Veerasamy Ringadoo	1
4(c)(i)	A poor country with few prospects	1
4(c)(ii)	Any two: free education; public health system / reduced infant mortality (1 each)	2
4(c)(iii)	"Economic miracle" means an unexpected rapid transformation from poverty to prosperity (1); evidence: from a poor country at independence to one of Africa's most prosperous in three decades (1)	2
4(c)(iv)	Yes — educated workers can perform higher-skilled jobs in finance and ICT; literacy helps people participate in the economy and earn more (any reasonable explanation)	1
4(d)	Any post-independence leader (e.g. Sir Anerood Jugnauth — made Mauritius a republic / EPZ development; Paul Béranger; Navin Ramgoolam) + one achievement (1 each)	2
4(e)	B — "Stella Clavisque Maris Indici"	1
5 (essay)	8 marks: background/early career (1); founding/joining MLP (1); role in independence negotiations (2); achievements as PM: free education, EPZ, health, welfare (2); Republic / later years (1); how remembered today / "Father of the Nation" (1). Award for structure and knowledge.	8
6(a)(i)	Services (financial services, ICT, tourism) at 74%	1
6(a)(ii)	4% (1); at independence it was 93%, so it has fallen dramatically / decreased hugely (1)	2
6(a)(iii)	Gross Domestic Product = the total value of all goods and services produced in a country in a year	1
6(b)	Any three: earns foreign currency; creates employment; supports hospitality/service sector; promotes Mauritian culture; income for government taxes (1 each)	3
6(c)	Any two: environmental damage / pollution; overcrowding of beaches; cultural disruption; dependence on external factors (e.g. airline strikes, pandemics); seasonal employment (1 each)	2
6(d)	ICT = information technology/computer/digital services sector (1); important because it provides high-skilled, well-paid jobs; diversifies the economy; not dependent on weather; attracts international business (any 1 further point)	2

Q	Answer	Marks
6(e)	B — A financial services hub and upmarket tourist destination	1
6(f)	Advantage: brings in foreign currency / jobs (1); Disadvantage: vulnerable to global events (pandemics, recessions) (1) — accept 1 mark for any reasonable answer	1
7(a)	Grown in north and east of Mauritius (1); harvested and crushed; juice boiled to make raw sugar (1); exported for foreign earnings; historically the backbone of the economy and shaped social structure (1); award up to 4 marks for comprehensive answer	4
7(b)	Any two: vegetables (tomatoes, potatoes, beans); tea; fruits (papaya, pineapple); tobacco (1 each)	2
7(c)	Any two: cheap labour; no import duties on goods; tax incentives; ready workforce; good infrastructure at Port Louis (1 each)	2
7(d)(i)	2.3 million km ²	1
7(d)(ii)	Tuna (1); exported to Europe (1)	2
7(d)(iii)	To ensure fish stocks do not run out / to protect the marine environment for future generations	1
8(a)	Republic of Mauritius	1
8(b)	Any two: heads the government; appoints ministers; sets national policy; leads Cabinet; represents Mauritius internationally (1 each)	2
8(c)	The Supreme Court is the highest court in Mauritius (1); it interprets the constitution, hears appeals, and protects fundamental rights (1)	2
8(d)	Any three correct holidays + what they celebrate: Independence Day 12 March (independence 1968); Republic Day 12 March (became republic 1992); National Day; Abolition Day 1 Feb; Diwali; Eid; Christmas; Chinese Spring Festival; Ugadi; Maha Shivaratri etc. (1 mark per holiday + celebration, max 3)	3
9(a)	Democracy = a system of government where people choose their leaders through free elections (1); any one feature: freedom of speech; right to vote; free press; independent judiciary (1)	2
9(b)	An MP represents the people of their constituency in Parliament (1); votes on laws; raises issues on behalf of constituents; holds government to account (any 1 additional point)	2
9(c)	B — The people through free and fair elections	1
9(d)	Any two: right to education; freedom of expression/speech; right to vote; freedom of religion; right to a fair trial; right to equal treatment (1 each)	2

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